

# Interaction between fluids and Helfrich membranes

Dennis Wörthmüller,<sup>1,2</sup> Pierre Sens,<sup>1,2</sup> and Michele Castellana<sup>1,2,\*</sup>

<sup>1</sup>*Institut Curie, PSL Research University, Paris, France*

<sup>2</sup>*CNRS UMR168, 11 rue Pierre et Marie Curie, 75005, Paris, France*

(Dated: February 12, 2026)

## I. INTRODUCTION

## II. FLUID AND RIGID BODY

In this Section, we will discuss the interaction between a **bulk fluid** (**F**) and the simplest structure—a **rigid body** (**R**) which is only allowed to turn about one point.

In all the systems that we will consider, we will introduce the **reference** (**r**) and **current** (**c**) configuration [2–4], see Fig. 1. All quantities relative to the **r** and **c** configuration will be denoted by the superscript **r** and **c**, respectively. In the **r** configuration, the region occupied by the bulk fluid is described by Cartesian coordinates  $\mathbf{x}_r$ . The axis of the ellipse, e.g. the rigid body, lies parallel to the  $x_c^1$  axis. In the **c** configuration, the region occupied by the bulk fluid is described by Cartesian coordinates  $\mathbf{x}_c$ . The axis of the ellipse, **R**, forms an angle  $\theta$  (red arc) with respect to the  $x_c^1$  axis.

The **r** configuration, is related to the **c** one as follows [2], see Fig. 1. At time  $t$ , the point  $\mathbf{x}_c$  corresponds to a point  $\mathbf{x}_r$  in the reference configuration through the deformation field [5]

$$\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \mathbf{x}_c - \mathbf{x}_r. \quad (1)$$

and the deformation-gradient tensor

$$F_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \frac{\partial u_\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta}. \quad (2)$$

In what follows, greek indices  $\alpha, \beta, \dots$  will be used to denote vectors and tensors in two-dimensional Euclidean space—their position as upper or lower indices is thus immaterial [3, 6].

Here, we will denote the mapping between  $\mathbf{x}_c$  and  $\mathbf{x}_r$  in Eq. (1) with the fields

$$\mathbf{x}_c = \boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (3)$$

$$\mathbf{x}_r = \boldsymbol{\psi}^t(\mathbf{x}_c). \quad (4)$$

We denote the **F** velocity and surface tension by  $v_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c)$  and  $\zeta_F^c(\mathbf{x}_c)$ , respectively, where the superscript **c** specifies that these fields depend on the coordinate  $\mathbf{x}_c$  in the **c** configuration.

For each field  $v_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c)$ ,  $\zeta_F^c(\mathbf{x}_c)$  which depends on the coordinate  $\mathbf{x}_c$  in the **c** configuration, we introduce its counterpart in the **r** configuration:

$$v_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \equiv v_{F_c}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r), t), \quad (5)$$

$$\zeta_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \equiv \zeta_F^c(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r), t). \quad (6)$$

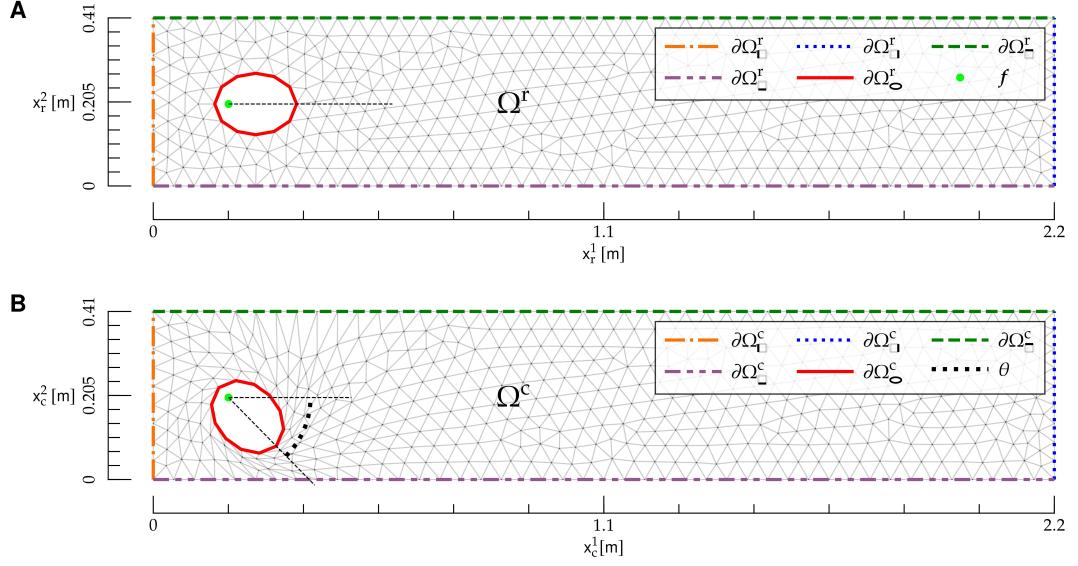
The solution of the interaction dynamics between **F** and **R** is involved because of the presence of the moving boundary  $\partial\Omega_\mathbf{D}^c$ , cf. Fig. 1. Following the **arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian** (ALE) procedure, we will bridge between the Lagrangian and the Eulerian description used to describe, respectively, **R** and **F** [2]. To achieve this, in what follows we will write the equations of motion for **R** and **F**, which are naturally formulated the **c** configuration first, and then rewrite them in the **r** configuration.

Details on the motion of **R**, **F** and **bulk fluid domain** (**D**) can be found in Appendices A 1 to A 3, respectively, and the temporal discretization is discussed in Appendix A 4.

An example of the system dynamics is shown in Fig. 3, where we study the interaction between air (**F**) and an aerogel (**R**)—an ultra light solid material involving a large porous structure [7]. The channel dimension are  $L = 2.2$  m,  $h = 0.41$  m, which have been taken from the **Finite Element Analysis Tools 2D (FEAT2D)** DFG 2D-3 benchmark example for a fluid flow around a cylinder [8, 9], see Fig. 1. Given that the materials, such as **F** and **body** (**B**), are two dimensional, in what follows we will estimate their parameter values by considering their three-dimensional counterparts, and assume a unit thickness in the out-of-plane direction. The parameters for **B** have been estimated from the properties of air:  $\rho_F = 1$  Kg/m<sup>2</sup>,  $\eta_F = 10^{-5}$  Pa m sec [10]. The inflow velocity profile is chosen as a Poiseuille

---

\* Corresponding author: [michele.castellana@curie.fr](mailto:michele.castellana@curie.fr)



**FIG. 1:** **Reference** and **current** configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid and a rigid body. **A)** **Reference** configuration. The region  $\Omega^r$  is given by the rectangle  $0 \leq x_r^1 \leq L$ ,  $0 \leq x_r^2 \leq h$  with the elliptical hole, and is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the **reference** configuration are denoted by  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r$  and  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r$  (colored dashed lines). The ellipse focal point  $f$  (light green dot) is also shown. **B)** **Current** configuration. The region  $\Omega^c$  is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the **current** configuration are denoted by  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$  and  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$  (colored dashed lines), and the rotational angle  $\theta$  of the rigid body is shown as an arc (black dotted line). The Cartesian coordinates  $\mathbf{x}_c$  are also shown.

flow

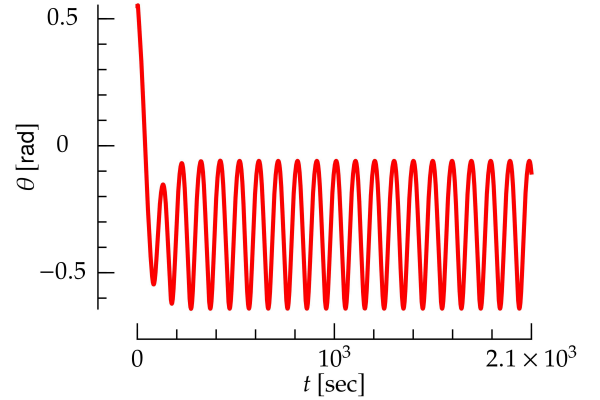
$$v_{F\Box}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{6v_0}{h^2} x_c^2 (x_c^2 - h), \quad (7)$$

with  $v_0 = 1$  m/sec. The **D** mesh stiffness exponent has been chosen to be  $\zeta = 3$  [2]. Finally, **R** is an ellipse with semi-axes  $a = 0.1$  m,  $b = 0.075$  m, center located at  $\mathbf{x}_r = (0.25 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$ , and moment of inertia  $I = 10^{-3} \text{ Kg m}^2$ , which corresponds to an aerogel density of  $\sim 6 \text{ Kg/m}^3$  [11]. As shown in Fig. 2, **R** has an oscillatory behavior, whose period can be understood with scaling arguments—see Appendix A 5.

### III. FLUID AND ELASTIC BODY

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Section II and put **F** into interaction with a more complex physical object—an **elastic body** (**E**); only the main results will be presented here.

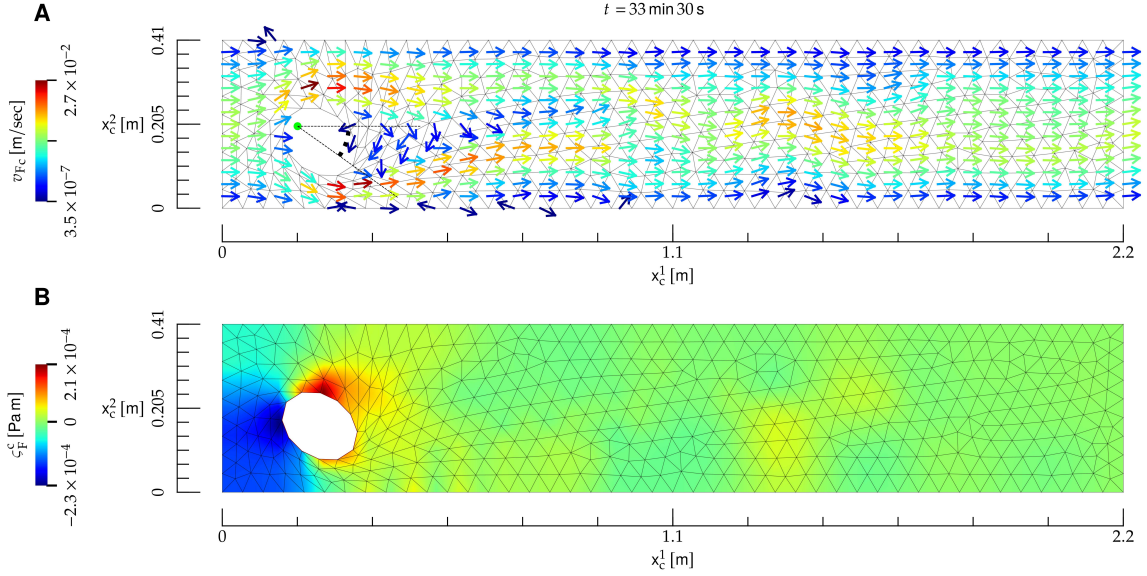
The **r** and **c** configurations are shown in Fig. 4. Here, the **E** boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\bigcirc}$  may deform, but the inner **E** boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\bullet}$  is pinned to the  $x_c^1$ ,  $x_c^2$



**FIG. 2:** Angle of the **rigid body** as a function of time for the interaction between a **bulk fluid** and a **rigid body** shown in Fig. 3.

plane. The equations of motion are reported in Appendix B 1, and the system dynamics is discussed in Appendix B 2.

An example of the coupled dynamics of **F** and **E** is shown in Fig. 5, where we show the interaction of a **F** with a hydrogel (**E**). Here,  $\partial\Omega_{\bigcirc}^r$  is an ellipse with semi-axes  $a = 0.2$  m,  $b = 0.1$  m and center



**FIG. 3:** Interaction between a **bulk fluid (F)** and a rigid **rigid body (R)**, whose material properties roughly correspond to air (**F**) and an aerogel (**R**). **A)** Temporal snapshot of the mesh (black lines) and velocity field (arrows) at the **current** time  $t$ , shown on top. The direction of the velocity field is indicated by the arrows, and its norm by their color; the direction of arrows with velocity close to zero is not defined. Here, **R** (ellipse) is allowed to pivot about its left focal point (red dot), and the related angle with respect to the  $x_c^1$  direction is denoted by a red arc. Here, the Reynolds number is  $R \sim 2 \times 10^2$ . **B)** Color map of the surface tension at the **current** instant of time  $t$ .

located at  $\mathbf{x}_r = (0.4 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$ , and  $\partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r$  has radius  $r = 0.0125 \text{ m}$  and center located at  $\mathbf{x}_r$ . The channel dimensions and **F** parameters have been taken from the **FEAT2D** DFG 2D-3 benchmark example for a fluid flow around a cylinder [8, 9]. The **E** density is  $\rho_E = 10^3 \text{ Kg/m}^2$  [12]. The storage modulus, which approximates the shear modulus  $\mu$  [13] is  $\sim 10 \text{ Kg/sec}^2$  [14]. Given a **E** Poisson ratio [3] of  $\nu \sim 0.49$  [15], we obtain  $K \sim 5 \times 10^2 \text{ Kg/sec}^2$  from the relation  $K = 2\mu(1 + \nu)/[3(2\nu - 1)]$  [3]. The **F** inflow velocity profile is a Poiseuille flow, Eq. (7), with  $v_0 = 1 \text{ m/sec}$ . Finally, the **D** mesh stiffness exponent has been chosen to be  $\zeta = 3$  [2].

#### IV. FLUID AND HELFRICH MEMBRANE

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Appendix B, and complexify the structure of the elastic body with which **F** interacts by considering, instead of an elastic material, an **Helfrich membrane (M)** [1, 16].

For this problem, we will consider the geometry depicted in Fig. 6. A vertical channel with mirror symmetry about its mid axis is considered.

The left boundary of the channel is  $\partial\Omega_{\square}$ , and the boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\square}$  lies on the symmetry axis. Fluid is injected from bottom to top on  $\partial\Omega_{\square}$ . **M** lies on the top boundary of **F**,  $\partial\Omega_{\square}$ , which coincides with the **M** manifold  $\partial\Omega_{\square}$ . Finally, we denote by  $\Omega$  the region enclosed by the boundaries, and all the quantities above will be considered in the **r** and **c** configurations.

The geometry of Fig. 6 may represent **F** being confined in a large reservoir, lying on bottom of the channel, where the channel is a vertical neck of the reservoir, covered on top by **M**.

##### A. Helfrich membrane motion

Both the physical nature and mathematical description of **M** is significantly more complex than that of **E**. First, unlike **E**, **M** has a fluid structure: its material elements can flow both tangentially and normally to it. Such fluid behavior requires an Eulerian description, which then needs to be connected to the Lagrangian description used to describe **D**. Second, **M** is described by fourth-order **partial differential equations (PDEs)** [17], which are significantly more complex than the second-order **PDEs** which describe **E** [18]. Third, the geometri-

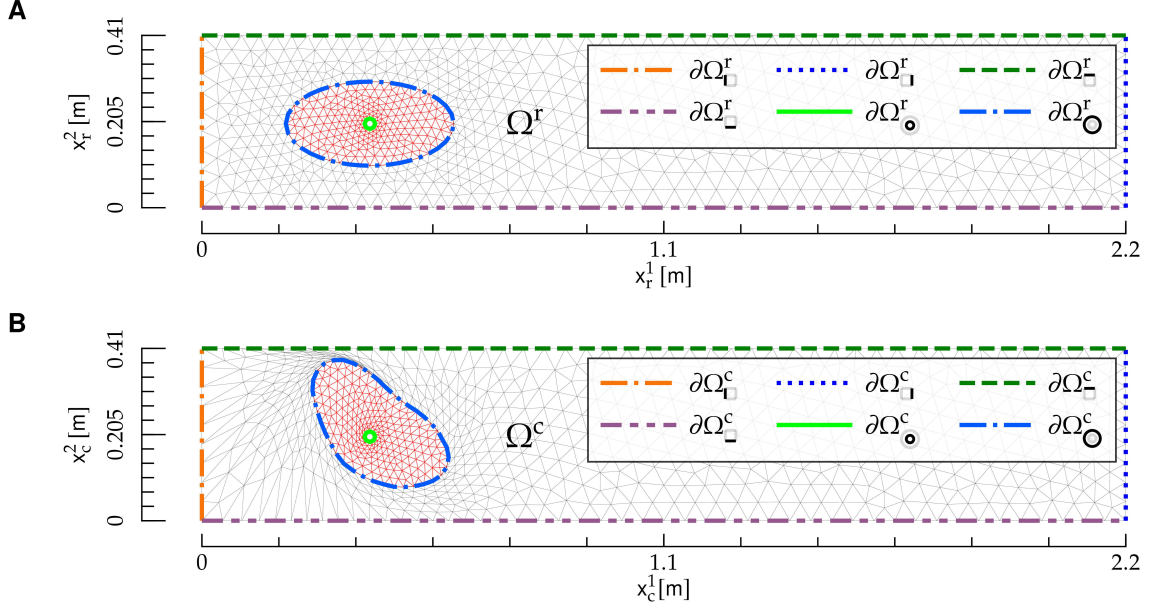


FIG. 4: **Reference** and **current** configuration for the interaction between a **bulk fluid** and an **elastic body**. The figures follows the same notation as Fig. 1.

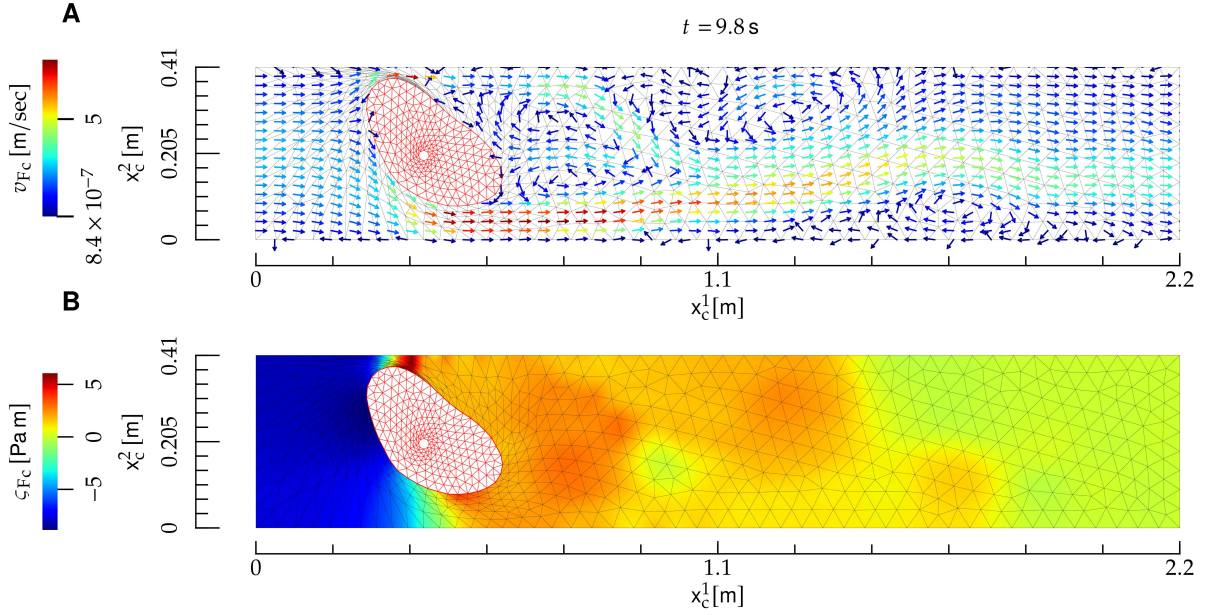


FIG. 5: Interaction between a **bulk fluid** and an **elastic body** (E) (a hydrogel). The notation is the same as in Fig. 3, and the **elastic body** is depicted as a red mesh. Here, the Reynolds number is  $R \sim 2 \times 10^2$ . The E deformation is not symmetric under the mirror symmetry  $x_c^2 \rightarrow h - x_c^2$ , where  $h$  is the height of the F domain, because the center of E is not located at  $x_c^2 = h/2$ .

cal description of **M** requires fixing an appropriate *gauge*. In fact, a general parametrization of **M** is given by two functions  $\mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1)$ . Both of these functions depend on the curvilinear coordinate  $x^1$  which is defined in the **r** domain of **M**,  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ , see

Fig. 6—note that here  $x^i$  differs from the Cartesian coordinate  $x^\alpha$ . Despite this pair of functions, a single PDE determines the **M** shape [17]. To understand this redundancy, consider the stretching



field  $\nu > 0$ , defined by

$$\nu^2 \equiv \mathbf{e}_1 \cdot \mathbf{e}_1, \quad (8)$$

$$\mathbf{e}_i \equiv \frac{\partial \mathbf{x}_c^M}{\partial x^i}. \quad (9)$$

It is then easy to realize that two parametrizations with different  $\nu$ s may yield the same physical shape. Such redundancy may be removed by a gauge fixing, i.e., by adding a constraint on  $\mathbf{x}_c^M$ , or its derivatives. Two common gauge choices are the Monge [19, 20], or the arc-length parametrization [1], in which one sets

$$\nu = 1. \quad (10)$$

The arc-length gauge has been used to describe, for instance, the steady state for membrane tubules [1]. However, while a static constraint such as (10) is suited to static shapes, it cannot describe the  $\mathbf{M}$  dynamics, such as the one of  $\mathbf{M}$  interacting with  $\mathbf{F}$ . In fact, as  $\mathbf{M}$  is deformed, it will also stretch: as a result, Eq. (10) must be replaced by a time-dependent gauge—see below.

We describe  $\mathbf{M}$  with the Lagrangian approach, along the lines of the description of  $\mathbf{D}$  in Section II and  $\mathbf{E}$  in Appendix B. The  $\mathbf{M}$  displacement field is

$$\mathbf{u}_M(x^1) \equiv \mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1) - \mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1), \quad (11)$$

where we choose the  $\mathbf{r}$  configuration as a straight line

$$\mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1) \equiv (x^1, h), \quad 0 \leq x^1 \leq L, \quad (12)$$

which is shown in Fig. 6A. In addition, we introduce the angle  $\psi$  formed by the tangent to  $\mathbf{M}$  with the  $x^1$  axis [1], defined by

$$e_1^1 = \nu \cos \psi, \quad (13)$$

$$e_1^2 = -\nu \sin \psi. \quad (14)$$

Finally, the  $\mathbf{M}$  metric tensor is defined by [6]

$$g_{ij} \equiv \mathbf{e}_i \cdot \mathbf{e}_j. \quad (15)$$

In what follows, latin indices  $i, j, k, \dots$  will be used to denote vectors and tensors related to the  $\mathbf{M}$  manifold; their position as upper and lower indexes is thus important [6]. Because the differential manifold of  $\mathbf{M}$  is one dimensional, indexes  $i, j, k, \dots$  may take only one value, i.e.,  $i = j = k = \dots = 1$ . However, in formal relations such as Eq. (15), we will use the general notation  $i, j, k, \dots$  for the sake of generality, and for potential extensions of such relations to two-dimensional manifolds [20].

In order to work out the dynamical equations for  $\mathbf{M}$ , let us derive the force exerted by  $\mathbf{F}$  on  $\mathbf{M}$ . The force exerted on a line element  $dl_c$  of  $\mathbf{M}$  is [5]

$$f_{F\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = -\sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c \hat{n}^c{}^\gamma(\nu, \psi), \quad (16)$$

where

$$\sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c \equiv \varsigma_F^c \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left( \frac{\partial v_{F\alpha}^c}{\partial x_c^\beta} + \frac{\partial v_{F\beta}^c}{\partial x_c^\alpha} \right) \quad (17)$$

is the  $\mathbf{F}$  stress tensor [5] and  $\hat{n}^c$  the unit normal to  $\partial\Omega_c^c$  pointing outside  $\Omega^c$ , see Fig. 6. In Eq. (16),  $\sigma_F^c$  is evaluated at the  $\mathbf{c}$  coordinate  $\mathbf{x}_c^M \in \partial\Omega_c^c$  corresponding to  $x^1$ . The components of the force (16) tangential and normal to  $\mathbf{M}$  are [20]

$$f_{Ft}^i(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = g^{ij}(\nu) e_j^\alpha(\nu, \psi) f_{\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) \quad (18)$$

$$f_{Fn}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = \hat{n}^c{}^\alpha(\nu, \psi) f_{\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi), \quad (19)$$

where in Eq. (18) we used the feature that the metric tensor depends on  $\nu$  only, see Eqs. (8) and (15).

The equations of motion for  $\mathbf{M}$  are [18, 21, 22]

$$\nabla_i v_M^i - 2H w_M = 0, \quad (20)$$

$$\rho_M \left( \frac{\partial v_M^i}{\partial t} + v_M^j \nabla_j v_M^i - 2v_M^j w_M b_j^i - w_M \nabla^i w_M \right) = \nabla^i \varsigma_M + f_{\eta_M t}^i + f_{Ft}^i, \quad (21)$$

$$\rho_M \left[ \frac{\partial w_M}{\partial t} + v_M^i (v_M^j b_{ji} + \nabla_i w_M) \right] = 2\varsigma_M H + f_{\kappa} + f_{\eta_M n} + f_{Fn}, \quad (22)$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{u}_M}{\partial t} = w_M \hat{n}^c, \quad (23)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^1}{\partial x^1} = -1 + \nu \cos \psi, \quad (24)$$

and they hold for  $x^1 \in \Omega_-^r$ . Here,  $v_M^i$  and  $w$  are the **M** tangential and normal velocity, respectively,  $\nabla$  is the covariant derivative related to the Levi-Civita connection associated to  $g$ ,  $\nabla_{LB}$  the Laplace-Beltrami operator,  $b$  the second fundamental form, and  $H$  and  $K$  the mean and Gaussian curvature, respectively. We refer to [6, 18, 20, 22] for details on the differential-geometry formulation, and we will now discuss each line in Eqs. (20) to (25). Equation (20) enforces mass conservation [5]. Equations (21) and (22) are the tangential and normal components of the **Navier-Stokes (NS)** equations, respectively. The first term in the **right-hand side (RHS)** of Eq. (21) represents the force on membrane elements induced by gradients of line tension, while the first term in the **RHS** of Eq. (22) constitutes Laplace pressure [5, 23]. The other terms read

$$f_\kappa(\nu, \psi) \equiv \quad (26)$$

$$-2\kappa[\nabla_i \nabla^i H + 2H(H^2 - K)],$$

$$f_{\eta_M t}^i(v_M, w_M, \nu, \psi) \equiv \quad (27)$$

$$\eta_M[-\nabla_{LB} v_M^i -$$

$$2(b^{ij} - 2H g^{ij}) \nabla_j w_M + 2K v_M^i],$$

$$f_{\eta_M n}(v_M, w_M, \nu, \psi) \equiv \quad (28)$$

$$2\eta_M[(\nabla^i v_M^j) b_{ij} - 2w_M(2H^2 - K)].$$

In Eq. (26),  $f_\kappa$  represents the resistance of **M** to bending, and it is derived from Helfrich model [16], while  $f_{\eta_M t}$  and  $f_{\eta_M n}$  in Eqs. (27) and (28) are, respectively, the tangential and normal component of the viscous force resulting from in-membrane flows [22]. Equation (23) is the time-evolution equation for the **M** shape, which evolves according to the normal  $\hat{n}^c$ , and it has been obtained from Eqs. (11) and (12). Equations (24) and (25) re-express the definitions of  $\nu$  and  $\psi$ , and they result from Eqs. (9) and (11) to (14). Finally,  $\rho_M$ ,  $\varsigma_M$  and  $\kappa$  are, respectively, the density, line tension and bending rigidity of **M**.

We choose the following **boundary conditions (BCs)** for Eqs. (20) to (25):

$$v_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (29)$$

$$v_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (30)$$

$$w_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (31)$$

$$\nabla_i w_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (32)$$

$$\varsigma_M = \varsigma_{M,-} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (33)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (34)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^2}{\partial x^1} = -\nu \sin \psi, \quad (25)$$

$$u_M^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r, \quad (35)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^2}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_-^r. \quad (36)$$

Equations (29), (31) and (34) enforce the condition that the left extremity of **M**,  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ , is clamped on the channel wall  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ . Equations (30), (32), (35) and (36) enforce the mirror symmetry about  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ . Namely, Eq. (30) ensures that the  $v_M$  vector field vanishes on  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ , because a nonzero value of this field on  $\partial\Omega_-^r$  would break the axial symmetry. The condition (35) follows the same lines. In addition, the symmetry requires that scalar fields and vertical components of vector fields in  $\Omega$  have zero slope with respect to  $x^1$  at  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ , see Eqs. (32) and (36). Finally, Eq. (33) fixes the **M** tension on  $\partial\Omega_-^r$ .

## B. Bulk fluid domain motion

We will determine  $\mathbf{u}_D$  as the solution of a **boundary-value problem (BVP)** given by the following elastic model [2, 24]

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (37)$$

where the elastic stress tensor  $S_D$  is given by

$$S_{D\alpha\beta} \equiv F_{\alpha\gamma} T_{\gamma\beta}, \quad (38)$$

and

$$T_{\alpha\beta} \equiv K(\mathbf{u}_D) E_{\gamma\gamma} \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \quad (39)$$

$$2\mu(\mathbf{u}_D) \left( E_{\alpha\beta} - \frac{1}{2} \delta_{\alpha\beta} E_{\gamma\gamma} \right),$$

$$E_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{1}{2} (F_{\gamma\alpha} F_{\gamma\beta} - \delta_{\alpha\beta}), \quad (40)$$

$$K(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}, \quad (41)$$

$$\mu(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}. \quad (42)$$

In Eqs. (41) and (42), we included an additional dependence of bulk modulus  $K$  and the shear modulus  $\mu$  on the deformation-gradient tensor (2). In the absence of this dependence, the elastic model above would be unstable under local compression [2]. In fact, the model's Lagrangian would not penalize configurations with small  $\det F$ . The inclusion of

the dependence (41) and (42) on  $\det F$  allows for penalizing these configurations—the larger the exponent  $\zeta > 0$ , the stronger the penalty. As a result, this dependence makes the model stable under mesh compression, such as the one shown below **R** in Fig. 1B.

The equation of motion for  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$  is obtained by deriving Eq. (37) with respect to time, and using the fact that  $\mathbf{r}$  coordinates are time independent:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}^{\beta}} \frac{dS_{\mathbf{D}\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}})}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^{\mathbf{r}}. \quad (43)$$

We impose the following BCs for Eqs. (37) and (43):

$$\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}} \cup \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (44)$$

$$u_{\mathbf{D}}^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (45)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_{\mathbf{D}}^2}{\partial x_{\mathbf{r}}^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (46)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{M}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (47)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}} \cup \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (48)$$

$$\dot{u}_{\mathbf{D}}^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (49)$$

$$\frac{\partial \dot{u}_{\mathbf{D}}^2}{\partial x_{\mathbf{r}}^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (50)$$

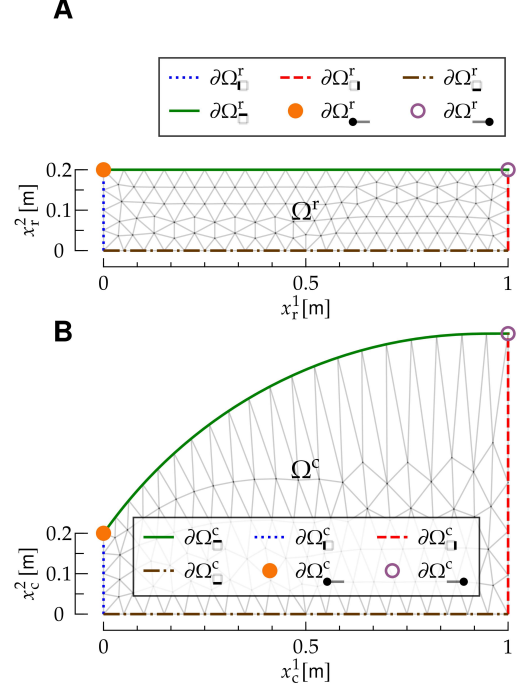
$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}} = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{M}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}. \quad (51)$$

Equation (44) ensures that **D** is not deformed on  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}} \cup \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}$ , cf. Eq. (A18). Equations (45) and (46) follow from axial symmetry, and Eq. (47) from the requirement that **D** and **M** deformations stay conforming [2]. Finally, the BCs for  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{M}}$ , Eqs. (48) to (51), are derived along the same lines as Eqs. (44) to (47).

We observe that Eqs. (38) to (42) imply that Eqs. (37) and (43) contains up to second derivatives of  $\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$ . As a result, the BCs (44) to (51) uniquely determine the solution of the BVP (37) and (43) [25].

### C. Bulk fluid motion

We will now discuss the **F** equations of motion, and present them first in **c** configuration coordinates, and then transform them in **r** coordinates.



**FIG. 6:** Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid (**F**) and a Helfrich membrane (**M**). The figure follows the same notation as Fig. 1. The top edge of the **F** mesh,  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}$ , coincides with the one-dimensional manifold  $\Omega_{\mathbf{M}}^{\mathbf{r}}$  of **M**.

#### 1. Equations of motion in current configuration coordinates

In **c** coordinates, the **F** equations of motion are the NS and continuity equations [5]:

$$\rho_{\mathbf{F}} \left( \partial_t v_{\mathbf{F}}^{\alpha} + v_{\mathbf{F}}^{\beta} \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}}^{\alpha}}{\partial x_{\mathbf{c}}^{\beta}} \right) = \frac{\partial \sigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\alpha\beta}}{\partial x_{\mathbf{c}}^{\beta}}, \quad (52)$$

$$\frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}}^{\alpha}}{\partial x_{\mathbf{c}}^{\alpha}} = 0, \quad (53)$$

and they hold for  $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}} \in \Omega^{\mathbf{c}}$ . Equations (52) and (53) describe the **F** motion in a flat, two-dimensional geometry [5]—an example of the corresponding NS equations on a curved geometry is given by Eq. (21).

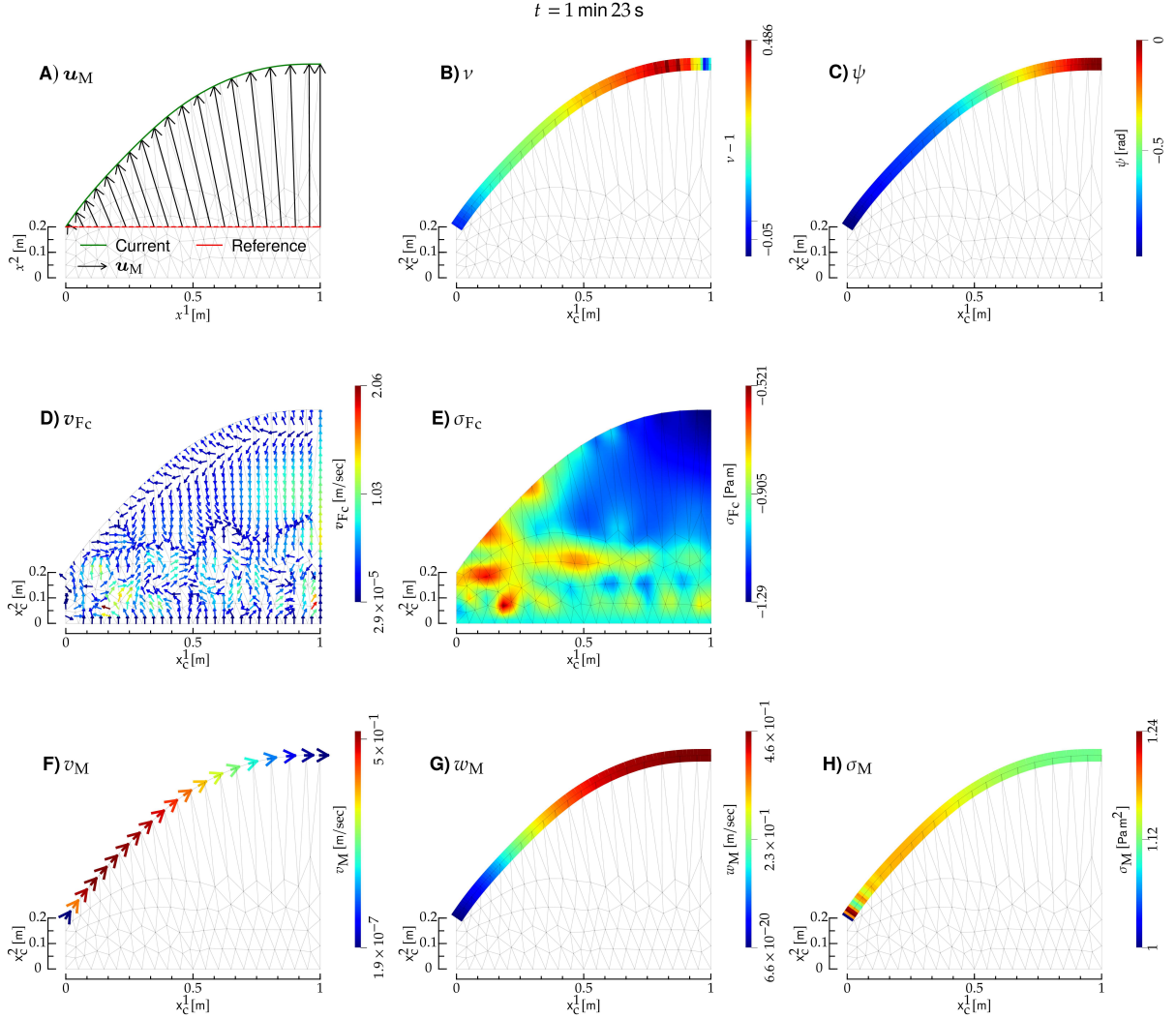
We enforce the following BCs for Eqs. (52) and (53):

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}} = \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}, \quad (54)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}, \quad (55)$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}}^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}, \quad (56)$$

$$\frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}}^2}{\partial x_{\mathbf{c}}^2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}, \quad (57)$$



**FIG. 7:** Interaction between a **bulk fluid** (**F**) and a **Helfrich membrane** (**M**). Here, **F** is air, and **M** an elastomer, and the **F** Reynolds number is  $R \sim 200$ . **A)** **Reference** (r) and **current** (c) configuration of **M** (red and green curve, respectively), and **M** displacement field  $\mathbf{u}_M$  (black arrows). **B)** Stretch field of **M**. **C)** Tangent angle of **M**. **D)** and **E)**: **F** velocity and tension, respectively; the notation is the same as in Fig. 3. **F)**, **G)** and **H)**: Tangential velocity, normal velocity and tension of **M**, respectively. All panels refer to the same instant of time, shown on top, and they display also the deformed mesh (gray lines).

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \left. \frac{d\mathbf{u}_M(x^1)}{dt} \right|_{x^1=[\psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c)]^1} \quad \text{on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (58)$$

$$\varsigma_F = \varsigma_{F_{\square}} \quad \text{on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c. \quad (59)$$

According to Eq. (54), **F** is injected from the bottom edge of  $\Omega^c$ ,  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ , while Eq. (55) is a no-slip **BC** on the left wall  $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ , and Eqs. (56) and (57) result from symmetry. Equation (58) ensures that the motion of **F** is conforming to that of **M** [2]: In fact, Eq. (23) ensures that **M** only moves normally to its profile, and Eq. (58) thus ensures that **F**

stays in contact with **M** throughout its motion. On the other hand, Eq. (58) implies a tangential slip between **M** and **F**, allowing for the tangential part of the **F** and **M** velocities to differ. Finally, Eq. (59) stems from the presence of the reservoir, in which the **F** tension is equal to  $\varsigma_{F_{\square}}$ : At the boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$  between the channel and the reservoir, the **F** tension matches the reservoir's.



the  $\mathbf{r}$  coordinate  $\mathbf{x}_r$ . The equations of motion (52) and (53) yield, respectively,

## 2. Equations of motion in *reference* configuration coordinates

We will now rewrite the equations of motion and the BCs of Section IV C 1 in terms of  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}$ ,  $\varsigma_F^r$ , and

$$\rho_F \left\{ \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial t} + \left[ v_{F_r}^\gamma(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - \frac{d\varphi^{\gamma t}(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \right] G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right\} = \quad (60)$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial \varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left[ G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right],$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (61)$$

which hold in  $\Omega^r$ . In Eqs. (60) and (61) the tensor  $G$  is given by the inverse of  $F$  [2]:

$$G_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv [F(\mathbf{u})]_{\alpha\beta}^{-1}. \quad (62)$$

equations for  $\mathbf{M}$ ,  $\mathbf{D}$  and  $\mathbf{F}$ . The dynamics of the system is obtained as follows.

Following the CN temporal-discretization scheme [33], we define fields at staggered, integer and semi-integer time steps [32]: For example, we set

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \mathbf{v}_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t_n), \quad (63)$$

$$\varsigma_F^{r, n-1/2}(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \varsigma_F^r\left(\mathbf{x}_r, \frac{t_n + t_{n-1}}{2}\right), \quad (64)$$

## D. Temporal discretization

To numerically solve for the dynamics in a time span  $0 \leq t \leq T$ , we discretize time by setting  $\Delta t \equiv T/N$ ,  $t_n \equiv n \Delta t$ , with  $n = 0, 1, \dots, N$ .

We combine the Crank Nicolson (CN) discretization method for NS equations [32, 33] with the ALE formulation, by discretizing the dynamical

and similarly for other  $\mathbf{F}$  and  $\mathbf{M}$  fields.

### 1. Helfrich membrane

We discretize Eqs. (20) to (25) as follows

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} v_M^i - 2H^{n-1/2} w_M^n = 0, \quad (65)$$

$$\rho_M \left( \frac{v_M^{n,i} - v_M^{n-1,i}}{\Delta t} + \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,j} \nabla_j^{n-1/2} v_M^{n-1,i} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,j} \nabla_j^{n-1/2} v_M^{n-2,i} - 2 v_M^{n-1,j} w_M^{n-1} b^{n-1/2,i}_j - \right. \quad (66)$$

$$\left. w_M^{n-1} \nabla^{n-1/2,i} w_M^{n-1} \right) =$$

$$\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \varsigma_M^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M}^i \left( \frac{\mathbf{v}_M^n + \mathbf{v}_M^{n-1}}{2}, \frac{w_M^n + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2} \right) +$$

$$f_{F_t}^i(\sigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r, n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}),$$

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_M \left( \frac{w_M^n - w_M^{n-1}}{\Delta t} + v_M^{n-1,i} v_M^{n-1,j} b_{ji}^{n-1/2} + \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,i} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^{n-1} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,i} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^{n-2} \right) = \quad (67) \\ f_\kappa(\nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + 2\varsigma_M^{n-1/2} H^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M n} \left( \frac{\mathbf{v}_M^n + \mathbf{v}_M^{n-1}}{2}, \frac{w_M^n + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2} \right) + \\ f_{F n}(\sigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}), \end{aligned}$$

---

form of the BCs (29) to (36) reads, respectively,

$$\frac{u_M^{n-1/2} - u_M^{n-3/2}}{\Delta t} = w_M^{n-1} \hat{n}^{c n-1/2}, \quad (68)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,1}}{\partial x^1} = -1 + \nu^{n-1/2} \cos \psi^{n-1/2}, \quad (69)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,2}}{\partial x^1} = -\nu^{n-1/2} \sin \psi^{n-1/2}. \quad (70)$$

In Eqs. (66) and (67),  $\sigma_F^r$  denotes the **F** stress tensor in the **r** configuration:

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^{r t}(\mathbf{x}_r) &\equiv \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c(\varphi^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \quad (71) \\ &= \varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left[ G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} + \right. \\ &\quad \left. G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\beta}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right]. \end{aligned}$$

Proceeding along the same lines, the discrete

---

$$v_M^{n,i} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (72)$$

$$v_M^{n,i} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (73)$$

$$w_M^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (74)$$

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (75)$$

$$\varsigma_M^{n-1/2} = \varsigma_{M\bullet-}^r \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (76)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (77)$$

$$u_M^{n-1/2,1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (78)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,2}}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r. \quad (79)$$

In what follows, we will split the **BVP** into three steps [32, 36]:

**1. Approximated velocities.** Proceeding along the lines of the splitting scheme for **F** of Appendix A 4 b, we introduce the auxiliary velocities  $\bar{v}_M$  and  $\bar{w}_M$ , which approximate, respectively,  $\mathbf{v}_M^n$  and  $w_M^n$  [36]. We define  $\bar{v}_M$  and  $\bar{w}_M$  as solutions of the **PDEs**

$$\rho_M \left[ \frac{\bar{v}_M^i - v_M^{n-1,i}}{\Delta t} + \left( \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,j} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,j} \right) \nabla_j^{n-1/2} V_M^i - 2V_M^j W_M b^{n-1/2,j}_i - W_M \nabla^{n-1/2,i} W_M \right] = \quad (80)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \varsigma_M^* + f_{\eta_M, t}^i(\mathbf{V}_M, W_M, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + \\ &f_{F t}^i(\varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}), \end{aligned}$$

$$\rho_M \left[ \frac{\bar{w}_M - w_M^{n-1}}{\Delta t} + V_M^i V_M^j b_{ji}^{n-1/2} + \left( \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,i} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-3/2,i} \right) \nabla_i^{n-1/2} W_M \right] = \quad (81)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &f_\kappa(\nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + 2\varsigma_M^* H^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M n}(\mathbf{V}_M, W_M, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + \\ &f_{F n}(\varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}), \end{aligned}$$

---

where we have set

$$V_M^i \equiv \frac{\bar{v}_M^i + v_M^{n-1,i}}{2}, \quad (82)$$

$$W_M \equiv \frac{\bar{w}_M + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \quad (83)$$

$$\varsigma_M^* \equiv \varsigma_M^{n-3/2}, \quad (84)$$

Equations (80) and (81) are the analog of Eqs. (66) and (67), respectively, with a fixed pressure field  $\varsigma_M^*$  from the preceding step—in what follows, we will synonymously use the terms ‘pressure’ and ‘tension’ for conciseness [18].

Overall, Eqs. (80) and (81) determine  $\bar{v}_M$  and  $\bar{w}_M$ .

**2. Pressure correction.** Subtracting Eqs. (66) and (80) and neglecting  $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$  [18], we obtain

$$\rho_M \frac{v_M^{n,i} - \bar{v}_M^i}{\Delta t} = -\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \phi_M, \quad (85)$$

where we have defined the pressure increment as

$$\phi_M \equiv \varsigma_M^* - \varsigma_M^{n-1/2}. \quad (86)$$

Proceeding along the same lines for Eqs. (67) and (81), we obtain

$$w_M^n = \bar{w}_M. \quad (87)$$

By taking the covariant derivative of Eq. (85) and using the mass-conservation equation (65) and Eq. (87), we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} \nabla^{n-1/2,i} \phi_M = \quad (88) \\ \frac{\rho_M}{\Delta t} (\nabla_i^{n-1/2} \bar{v}_M^i - 2H^{n-1/2} \bar{w}_M). \end{aligned}$$

Equation (88) is a second-order PDE which determines  $\phi_M$ , and thus the tension  $\varsigma_M^{n-1/2}$  through Eq. (86).

**3. Velocity correction.** The **M** velocity  $\mathbf{v}_M^n$  is determined by means of Eq. (88) in terms of  $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_M$  and  $\phi_M$ .

The BCs for Eqs. (68) to (70), (80), (81), (85), (87) and (88) are

$$\bar{v}_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (89)$$

$$\bar{v}_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (90)$$

$$\bar{w}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (91)$$

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} \bar{w}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (92)$$

$$\phi_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (93)$$

$$n_{M_i}^{n-1/2} \nabla^{n-1/2,i} \phi_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (94)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (95)$$

$$u_M^{n-1/2,1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (96)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,2}}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r. \quad (97)$$

In Eq. (94),  $\mathbf{n}_M$  is the unit normal to  $\partial\Omega_{\bullet-}$ : It lies in the tangent bundle of  $\Omega_{\bullet-}$ , it is directed outside  $\Omega_{\bullet-}$ , and it is normalized according to  $n_{M_i}^i n_{M_i} = 1$  [6, 18, 26].

## 2. Bulk fluid domain

The discretization of the equations of motion for **D** proceeds along the same lines as in Section II, see Appendix A 4 c. The discrete version of the PDEs (37) and (43) is

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^n)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (98)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} \frac{dS_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^n)}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (99)$$

with BCs given by the discrete version of Eqs. (44) to (51):

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square-}^r, \quad (100)$$

$$u_D^{n,1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (101)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_D^{n,2}}{\partial x_r^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (102)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (103)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square-}^r, \quad (104)$$

$$\dot{u}_D^{n,1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (105)$$

$$\frac{\partial \dot{u}_D^{n,2}}{\partial x_r^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (106)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square-}^r. \quad (107)$$

## 3. Bulk fluid

The discretization of the equations of motion for **F** proceeds along the same lines as in Section II, see Appendix A 4 b.

The PDEs for **F** are

$$\rho_F \left\{ \frac{\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n-1, \alpha}}{\Delta t} + \left[ \frac{3}{2} (v_{F_r}^{n-1, \gamma} - \dot{u}_D^{n-1, \gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) - \frac{1}{2} (v_{F_r}^{n-2, \gamma} - \dot{u}_D^{n-2, \gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-2}) \right] \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right\} = \quad (108)$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \zeta_F^{r*}}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left( G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right),$$

$$\frac{\rho_F}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \bar{v}_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} = \quad (109)$$

$$G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \left( G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right),$$

where

$$\mathbf{V}_F \equiv \frac{\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F + \mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}}{2}, \quad (110)$$

$$\zeta_F^{r*} \equiv \zeta_F^{r, n-3/2}, \quad (111)$$

$$\phi_F \equiv \zeta_F^{r*} - \zeta_F^{r, n-1/2}. \quad (112)$$

The BCs for Eqs. (108) and (109) are

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (113)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (114)$$

$$\bar{v}_F^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (115)$$

$$G(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})_{\alpha 1} \frac{\partial V_F^2}{\partial x_r^\alpha} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (116)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F(x^1, h) = \dot{u}_M^{n-1/2}(x^1) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (117)$$

$$\phi_F = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (118)$$

$$\hat{n}^r \gamma G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\beta} = \quad (119)$$

$$0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^l,$$

$$G(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})_{\alpha 1} \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\alpha} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (120)$$

Finally,  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$  is determined from  $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$  and  $\zeta_F^{r, n-1/2}$  by means of the relation

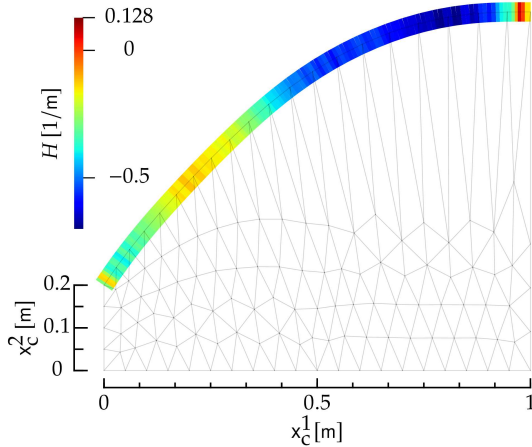
$$\rho_F \frac{\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n, \alpha}}{\Delta t} = G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\beta} \text{ in } \Omega^r. \quad (121)$$

Given the **M** fields  $v_M^{n-1, i}$ ,  $w_M^{n-1, i}$ ,  $\zeta_M^{n-3/2}$ ,  $\mathbf{u}_M^{n-3/2}$ ,  $\nu^{n-3/2}$ ,  $\psi^{n-3/2}$ , the **D** fields  $\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}$ ,  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ , and the **F** fields  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$ ,  $\zeta_F^{r, n-3/2}$ , we determine the fields at the next time step  $n \rightarrow n+1$  as follows:

- **Update M.** The **M** fields  $v_M^{n, i}$ ,  $w_M^{n, i}$ ,  $\zeta_M^{n-1/2}$ ,  $\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2}$ ,  $\nu^{n-1/2}$ ,  $\psi^{n-1/2}$  are determined by solving the BVP given by Eqs. (68) to (70), (80), (81), (85) and (87) to (97).
- **Update D.** We determine the **D** displacement field and its time derivative,  $\mathbf{u}_D^n$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$ , from the BVPs given by Eqs. (98) to (107).
- **Update F.** We determine the **F** fields  $\mathbf{v}_M^n$  and  $\zeta_F^{r, n-1/2}$  by solving the BVP given by Eqs. (108), (109) and (113) to (120), and by solving Eq. (121).

The fields  $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}^n$ ,  $\zeta_F^{c, n-1/2}$  in the **c** configuration are then obtained from the respective fields in the **r** configuration through Eqs. (5) and (6).

An example of this dynamics is shown in Fig. 7, where we show the interaction between air (**F**) and an elastomer (**M**). The channel has dimensions  $L = 1$  m,  $h = 0.2$  m. Proceeding along the lines of Section II, **M** parameters have been estimated by considering the parameters for a three-dimensional material, multiplying them by a unit length corresponding to the out-of-plane depth, and by the **M** thickness, chosen to be  $\Delta = 10^{-3}$  m. The **M** bending rigidity  $\kappa$  has been estimated from the relation  $\kappa = E\Delta^3/[12(1-\nu^2)]$ , which expresses  $\kappa$  as a function of the Young modulus  $E$ , the Poisson ratio  $\nu$ , and  $\Delta$  [3]. Typical values for an elastomer are  $E \sim 10^7$  Pa [27] and  $\nu \sim 0.5$  [28], yielding  $\kappa = 10^{-3}$  Kg m<sup>3</sup>/sec<sup>2</sup>. We chose



**FIG. 8:** Curvature of the **Helfrich membrane** interacting with a **bulk fluid** shown in Fig. 7. The Figure follows the same notation and it corresponds to the same instant of time as Fig. 7.

$\rho_M = 1 \text{ Kg/m}$  and  $\eta_M = 1 \text{ Kg/m/sec}$  as the density and viscosity of an elastomer, respectively [29, 30], and we take  $\zeta_{M\bullet} = 1 \text{ N}$ . The **F** parameters have been estimated from the air parameters:  $\rho_F = 1 \text{ Kg/m}^2$ ,  $\eta_F = 10^{-5} \text{ Kg/sec}$  [10]. Also, we take  $\zeta_{F\Box} = -1 \text{ N/m}^2$ , and  $\mathbf{v}_{F\Box}^1 = 0$ ,  $\mathbf{v}_{F\Box}^2(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{3}{2L^2} \mathbf{x}_c^1 (2L - \mathbf{x}_c^1) v_0$ , where  $v_0 = 10^{-2} \text{ m/sec}$ , and  $\mathbf{v}_{F\Box}^2$  corresponds to a Poiseuille flow [5]. Finally, the **D** exponent is  $\zeta = 3$  [2].

## V. DISCUSSION

The **M** shape shown in Fig. 8 has a curvature which varies along the **M** profil, and thus differs from the classical circle-arc obtained at the interface between two fluids [5, 23].

## ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

We would like to thank S. Al-Izzi and S. Astruc for useful discussions, and the **finite element computational software** (FEniCS) online community for

its precious support.

This work was granted access to the high-performance computing resources of MesoPSL financed by the Region Île de France, and to the Abacus cluster at Institut Curie.

## Appendix A: Fluid and rigid body

### 1. Rigid body motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for **R**.

#### a. Equation of motion in **current**-configuration coordinates

The dynamics of **R** is given by the equations of motion for a rigid body which, in **c** coordinates, read [31]

$$I \frac{d\omega}{dt} = - \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}} dl_c \epsilon_{3\alpha\beta} \sigma_{F\beta\gamma}^c \hat{n}^c{}^\gamma, \quad (\text{A1})$$

$$\omega \equiv \frac{d\theta}{dt}. \quad (\text{A2})$$

Equation (A1) relates the angular acceleration of **R** to the torque of external forces. The moment of inertia of **R** is denoted by  $I$ . The **right-hand side** (RHS) of Eq. (A1) contains the line integral along the boundary of **R**, of the torque of the local force exerted by **bulk fluid** (**F**) on **R** with respect to the left focal point **f** of **R** [5], and  $\hat{n}^c$  is the normal to  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$  pointing towards  $\Omega^c$ .

This force is expressed in terms of the **F** stress tensor [5] in **c** coordinates  $\sigma_F^c$ , given by Eq. (17), where  $\eta_F$  and  $\rho_F$  are the two-dimensional viscosity and density of **F**, respectively. Also,  $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta\gamma}$  is the three-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol. Finally,  $dl_c$  is the line element of  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$  in the **c** configuration, and  $\hat{n}^c$  the unit boundary normal to  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$  pointing outside  $\Omega^c$ .

#### b. Equation of motion in the **reference**-configuration coordinates

In **r** coordinates, Eq. (A1) reads



$$\int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\varphi^{\alpha,t}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)) - f^\alpha] \sigma_{\mathbf{F}\beta\gamma}^{\mathbf{r}}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)) \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))) \frac{d\xi^\mu(s)}{ds}. \quad (\text{A3})$$

In Eq. (A3), the integral in the **RHS** is over the curvilinear boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c$ , which is parametrized as  $\mathbf{x}_r = \boldsymbol{\xi}(s)$ , where  $s$  is the curvilinear coordinate. Also,  $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta}$  is the two-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol [6], and  $\sigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}$  denotes the stress tensor in the **r** configuration, which is given by Eq. (71), where  $G$  is given by Eq. (62).

## 2. Fluid motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for **F**.

### a. Equations of motion in the **current**-configuration coordinates

The equations of motion, expressed in terms of the **c** fields  $v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}$  and  $\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}$ , are Eqs. (52) and (53), see Section IV C for details.

The **boundary conditions** (BCs) for Eqs. (52), (53), (A1) and (A2) are

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}^1(\mathbf{x}_c) = v_{\mathbf{F}\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A4})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}^2(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A5})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A6})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} [\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - f^\beta] \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c, \quad (\text{A7})$$

$$\eta_{\mathbf{F}} \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A8})$$

$$\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c. \quad (\text{A9})$$

Equations (A4) and (A5) ensure that **F** is injected on the boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$  in a direction parallel to the  $x_c^1$  axis, and Eq. (A6) is a no-slip **BC** [5] along the channel walls  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ , see Fig. 1. Equation (A7) ensures that, at the boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c$ , the **F** velocity matches the rotational velocity of **R**. Given that **R** can only rotate about its left focal point **f**, the **R** rotational velocity of a point  $\mathbf{x}_c \in \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c$  is given by

$$\frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} [\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - c_\beta], \quad (\text{A10})$$

where **R** is the rotation matrix corresponding to a counterclockwise rotation:

$$\mathbf{R}(\theta) \equiv \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A11})$$

Finally, Eqs. (A8) and (A9) ensure, respectively, that on  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$  there is zero traction and tension; this corresponds to the hypothesis that there is free flow at  $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$  [5, 32].

### b. Equations of motion in the **reference**-configuration coordinates

We will now rewrite the equations of motion and the **BCs** in terms of  $v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}$ ,  $\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}$ , and the **r** coordinate  $\mathbf{x}_r$ . The equations of motion (52) and (53) yield, respectively, Eqs. (60) and (61), see Section IV C 2. The **BCs** (A4) to (A9) yield as

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}^1(\mathbf{x}_r) = v_{\mathbf{F}\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A12})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}^2(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A13})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A14})$$

$$v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} (x_r^\beta - f^\beta) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}^c, \quad (\text{A15})$$

$$\eta_{\mathbf{F}} G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A16})$$

$$\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\mathbf{r}}. \quad (\text{A17})$$

## 3. Motion of **bulk fluid domain**

The equations of motion (60), (61), (A3) and (A12) to (A17) involve the displacement field  $\mathbf{u}_D$ , which describes how the region—or domain—which contains **F**, is deformed in time, cf. Fig. 1. We will denote this region as the **D**. We observe that this field has, so far, been left arbitrary, and we have the freedom to choose it.

Here,  $\mathbf{u}_D$  will be determined with an analogy with the theory of elasticity [2]. We imagine that, as **R**

rotates about its focal point, each point  $\mathbf{x}_r \in \Omega^r$  moves into a point  $\mathbf{x}_c \in \Omega^c$ , and that the domain  $\Omega^r$  is deformed, e.g., locally stretched and compressed, into  $\Omega^c$ , like an elastic medium. We will determine  $\mathbf{u}_D$  as the solution of a **boundary-value problem (BVP)** given by the elastic model (37), see Section IV B for details.

The BCs for the **partial differential equation (PDE)** (37) are

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (\text{A18})$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r. \quad (\text{A19})$$

Equation (A18) enforces the fact that the mesh is not deformed at the boundary  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r$ . Finally, Eq. (A19) ensures that the mesh deformation at  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r$  matches the deformation induced by the rotation of  $\mathbf{R}$ .

Equations (37), (A18) and (A19) constitute the **BVP** which determines  $\mathbf{u}_D$ . Along the lines of **BVPs** in the theory of elasticity, such **BVP** is already, naturally formulated in the  $\mathbf{r}$  configuration [3].

From the **BVP** above, we obtain a **BVP** for  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ , which will be needed in the following to describe the  $\mathbf{D}$  motion. By deriving both sides of Eqs. (37), (A18) and (A19), we obtain, respectively, Eq. (43) and

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (\text{A20})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (\text{A21})$$

where in Eqs. (A20) and (A21) we used the fact that  $\mathbf{x}_r$  is independent of time, and in Eq. (A21) we substituted Eq. (A2). The **left-hand side (LHS)** of Eq. (43) depends on the second partial derivatives of  $\mathbf{u}_D$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ —see Eqs. (38) to (42). As a result, given  $\theta$ ,  $\omega$ , and  $\mathbf{u}_D$  from Eqs. (37),

(A18) and (A19), the **BVP** (43), (A20) and (A21) determines  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ .

Overall Eqs. (37), (43), (60), (61), (A2), (A3) and (A12) to (A21) constitute a **BVP** for  $\theta, \omega, \mathbf{v}_{F_r}, \zeta_F^r, \mathbf{u}_D$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$  which, combined with the temporal **BCs**

$$\theta(t=0) = \theta_0 \quad (\text{A22})$$

$$\omega(t=0) = \omega_0 \quad (\text{A23})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t=0) = \mathbf{v}_{F_r0}(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (\text{A24})$$

$$\zeta_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t=0) = \zeta_{F0}^r(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (\text{A25})$$

determine the dynamics of the system.

#### 4. Temporal discretization

To numerically solve for the dynamics in a time span  $0 \leq t \leq T$ , we discretize time by setting  $\Delta t \equiv T/N$ ,  $t_n \equiv n \Delta t$ , with  $n = 0, 1, \dots, N$ .

We combine the **Crank Nicolson (CN)** discretization method for **Navier-Stokes (NS)** equations [32, 33] with the **arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian (ALE)** formulation, by discretizing the dynamical equations for  $\mathbf{R}$ ,  $\mathbf{F}$  and  $\mathbf{D}$ —see below.

##### a. Rigid body

Proceeding along the lines of the **CN** scheme [33], we define fields at staggered, integer and semi-integer time steps [32]—see for example Eqs. (63) and (64) for  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}$  and  $\zeta_F^r$ —and similarly for other quantities. We discretize Eqs. (A2) and (A3) and, neglecting  $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$ , we obtain

$$\frac{\theta^n - \theta^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \omega^n, \quad (\text{A26})$$

$$\frac{\omega^n - \omega^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = I \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\xi^\alpha(s) + u^{n-1, \alpha}(\xi(s)) - f^\alpha] \sigma_{F\beta\gamma}^{r, n-1}(\xi(s); \mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}, \zeta_F^{r, n-3/2}) \times \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}(\xi(s))) \frac{d\xi^\mu(s)}{ds}, \quad (\text{A27})$$

where in Eq. (A27) we used Eqs. (1) and (3) and we explicitly indicated the dependence of the stress

tensor (71) on  $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}$  and  $\zeta_F^c$ .

*b. Bulk fluid*

To discretize in time the **F** problem, we will apply the **CN** splitting scheme [32, 33] to the **NS** equations (60) and (61) in the **r** configurations. This splitting scheme is derived from the **incremental pressure correction scheme** [34], in which the solution of the **NS** equations is split into three intermediate steps. In what follows, we will synonymously use the terms ‘pressure’ and ‘surface tension’ for conciseness [18].

The discrete form of the **PDEs** Eqs. (60) and (61) is

$$\rho_F \left[ \frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} - v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} + \frac{3}{2}(v_{F_r}^{n-1,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-1,\gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} - \frac{1}{2}(v_{F_r}^{n-2,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-2,\gamma}) \times \right. \quad (\text{A28})$$

$$\left. G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-2}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n-2,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right] = G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \varsigma_F^{r,n-1/2}}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left[ G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \left( \frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} + v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) \right],$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (\text{A29})$$

where we omitted the dependence on  $\mathbf{x}_r$  for clarity. Also, in the **LHS** of Eq. (A28) we rewrote the convective term according to the Adams-Bashforth discretization scheme [32, 35], and we used Eqs. (1)

and (3) to rewrite the time derivative of  $\varphi$  in terms of  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ .

The discrete form of the **BCs** (A12) to (A17) reads

$$v_{F_r}^{n,1} = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A30})$$

$$v_{F_r}^{n,2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A31})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A32})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r} = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r, \quad (\text{A33})$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \left( \frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} + v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A34})$$

$$\varsigma_F^{r,n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (\text{A35})$$

We will now split the **BVP** into three steps [32, 36]:

1. **Approximated velocity.** We introduce the velocity  $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$ , which approximates the true velocity  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}$ , and which satisfies the **BVP** given by Eq. (108) and **BCs**

$$\bar{v}_F^1 = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (\text{A36})$$

$$\bar{v}_F^2 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (\text{A37})$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (\text{A38})$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\circ^r, \quad (\text{A39})$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r. \quad (\text{A40})$$

where  $\mathbf{V}_F$  and  $\zeta_F^r$  are given by Eqs. (110) and (111).

## 2. Pressure correction.

Subtracting Eqs. (108) and (A28) and neglecting  $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$ , we obtain Eq. (121), where the surface-tension increment  $\phi_F$  is defined by Eq. (112). By applying  $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\partial/\partial\mathbf{x}_r^\gamma$  to both sides of Eq. (121) and using Eq. (A29), we obtain the second-order **PDE** (109) for  $\phi_F$ .

We will now work out the **BCs** for Eq. (109). Equations (111), (112) and (A35) imply the **BC**

$$\phi_F = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r. \quad (\text{A41})$$

Multiplying Eq. (121) by  $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\hat{n}^{r\gamma}$ , where  $\hat{n}^r$  is the unit boundary normal in the  $\mathbf{r}$  configuration, we obtain

$$\frac{\rho_F}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \hat{n}^{r\gamma} (\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha}) = \quad (\text{A42})$$

$$\hat{n}^{r\gamma} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta}.$$

Combining Eq. (A42) with Eqs. (A30) to (A33) and (A36) to (A39), we obtain the second **BC**

$$\hat{n}^{r\gamma} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} = \quad (\text{A43})$$

$$0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r \cup \partial\Omega_\square^r \cup \partial\Omega_\circ^r.$$

The **BVP** (109), (A41) and (A43) determines  $\phi_F$  and, through the definition (112), the surface tension  $\zeta_c^{n-1/2}$ .

3. **Velocity correction.** The velocity  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$  is determined from the approximate velocity  $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$  from Eq. (121).

### c. Bulk fluid domain

The discrete version of the **BVP** for  $\mathbf{u}_D$ , Eqs. (37), (A18) and (A19), is given by Eq. (98) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (\text{A44})$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta^n) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\circ^r. \quad (\text{A45})$$

The discrete version of the **BVP** for  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ , Eqs. (43), (A20) and (A21), is given by Eq. (99) and

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (\text{A46})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\circ^r. \quad (\text{A47})$$

We can now iterate in time for the ensemble of fields of the **F-R** system as follows. At each step  $n$ , given  $\theta^{n-1}$ ,  $\omega^{n-1}$ ,  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$ ,  $\zeta_F^{r,n-3/2}$ ,  $\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$  from the preceding step, we

1. **Update R.** Solve the algebraic equations Eqs. (A26) and (A27) for  $\theta^n$  and  $\omega^n$ .
2. **Update D.** Solve the **BVPs** (98), (99) and (A44) to (A47) for  $\mathbf{u}_D^n$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$ .
3. **Update F.** Solve the **BVPs** (108) and (A36) to (A40) and (A41) to (A43) for  $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$  and  $\zeta_F^{r,n-1/2}$ , and obtain  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$  from Eq. (121).

The fields  $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}^{n-1}$ ,  $\varsigma_F^{n-3/2}$  in the **c** configuration are then obtained from the respective fields in the **r** configuration through Eqs. (5) and (6).

## 5. Characteristic time scale

As shown in Fig. 2, the dynamics of Fig. 3 involves a characteristic time scales  $\tau_B$ , i.e., the period of the angular oscillations of **B**. This time scale can be estimated by considering the dynamical equation (A1) for **B**, and approximating its LHS as  $I/\tau_B^2$  and its RHS as  $(\eta_F v_0/a)2\pi a$ . Here,  $\eta_F v_0/a$  is the viscous component of the force per unit length exerted by **F** on **B**, cf. Eq. (17),  $2\pi a$  estimates the total length of the boundary of **B**, and  $a$  approximates the lever arm of the force above. Putting everything together, we obtain

$$\tau_B \sim \sqrt{\frac{I}{2\pi a \eta_F v_0}}. \quad (\text{A48})$$

For the parameters of Fig. 3, Eq. (A48) yields  $\tau_B \sim 130$  sec, which is in agreement with the period of the oscillations in Fig. 2.

## Appendix B: Fluid and elastic body

### 1. Equations of motion

The equations of motion for the dynamics of **F** and elastic body (**E**) are the following.

First, the dynamics of **F** is governed by the NS and mass-conservation equations (52) and (53), respectively. Their BCs are Eqs. (A4) to (A6), (A8) and (A9), which stay unchanged with respect to Section II. On the other hand, BC (A7), which ensures that the **F** velocity matches the **B** velocity at the interface between **F** and **B**, now reads

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{d\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \Big|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c)} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^c \quad (\text{B1})$$

Second, the motion of **E** is governed by Newton's equations of motion for an elastic body [3]

$$\rho_E \frac{d^2 \mathbf{u}_E^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt^2} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta}, \quad (\text{B2})$$

where  $\rho_E$  is the density of **E**, which is assumed to be independent of space. Also,  $\mathbf{u}_E$  is the deformation

field of **E**, which is defined along the lines of Eq. (1).

The **E** stress tensor is derived from a compressible neo-Hookean model [37], and it reads

$$S_{E\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{\mu}{\det F} \left( -\frac{1}{2} C_{\gamma\gamma} G_{\alpha\beta} + F_{\beta\alpha} \right) + K[(\det(F))^2 - 1] G_{\alpha\beta}, \quad (\text{B3})$$

where

$$C_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + 2E_{\alpha\beta}. \quad (\text{B4})$$

We have chosen this model because it is stable under compression, i.e., its potential energy diverges as  $\det F \rightarrow 0$  [37]. As opposed to linear models [3] and to the elastic model of Appendix A3, this model proves to yield a stable dynamics for **E** as it is compressed by **F**, see below and Fig. 5. The BCs for Eq. (B2) are

$$\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B5})$$

$$S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^t)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\xi(s)} \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c(\varphi^t(\xi(s))) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\varphi^{t,\gamma}(\xi(s))}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B6})$$

In the LHS of Eq. (B6), the quantity  $\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds}$  represents the unit normal to  $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r$ , and similarly for the RHS.

Finally, the equations of motion for **D** are (37) and (43), with BCs (A18) and (A20) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{u}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B7})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B8})$$

Equation (B7) and Eq. (B8) ensure that the displacement and velocity of **E** and **D** are conforming at the **E-D** interface, and they replace Eqs. (A19) and (A21), respectively.

### 2. Dynamics

The system dynamics is obtained as follows: given  $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$ ,  $\varsigma_F^{n-3/2}$ ,  $\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}$ ,  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1}$ ,  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$  from the preceding step, we

- **Update E.** Solve for  $\mathbf{u}_E^n$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n$  the discrete version of Eq. (B2)

$$\rho_E \frac{\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n,\alpha} - \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta}, \quad (\text{B9})$$

$$\frac{\mathbf{u}_E^n - \mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E, \quad (\text{B10})$$

with BCs obtained from Eqs. (B5) and (B6):



$$\mathbf{u}_E^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B11})$$

$$\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \quad (\text{B12})$$

$$\sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^r(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s); \mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r\,n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_E^n) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} F_{\gamma\delta}(\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1})|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\delta}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r.$$

In Eq. (B12), we have used Eqs. (2) and (3) to rewrite the derivative of  $\phi(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))$ .

- **Update D.** Solve for  $\mathbf{u}_D^n$  and  $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$  the BVPs given by Eqs. (98) and (99) with BCs (A44), (A46) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B13})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B14})$$

- **Update F.** Solve the BVPs given by (108) and (109) and BCs (A36) to (A38), (A40), (A41) and (A43) and

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B15})$$

which replaces Eq. (A40) for a rigid body, and solve Eq. (121).

- 
- [1] I. Derényi, F. Jülicher, and J. Prost, Formation and Interaction of Membrane Tubes, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **88**, 238101 (2002).
  - [2] D. Kamensky, Lecture notes for MAE 207: Finite element analysis for coupled problems (2022).
  - [3] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifshitz, *Theory of Elasticity* (Elsevier, 1986).
  - [4] W. S. Slaughter, *The Linearized Theory of Elasticity* (Birkhäuser Boston, Boston, MA, 2002).
  - [5] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifschitz, *Fluid Mechanics* (Pergamon, 1987).
  - [6] S. Marchiafava, *Appunti Di Geometria Differenziale*, Vol. I, II, III (Edizioni Nuova Cultura, 2005).
  - [7] S. S. KISTLER, Coherent Expanded Aerogels and Jellies, *Nature* **127**, 741 (1931).
  - [8] H. Blum, J. Harig., S. Müller, S. Schreiber, and S. Turek, FEAT2D, Finite Element Analysis Tools User Manual (1995).
  - [9] M. Schafer and S. Turek, Benchmark Computations of Laminar Flow Around a Cylinder (1996).
  - [10] J. Hilsenrath, *Tables of Thermal Properties of Gases: Comprising Tables of Thermodynamic and Transport Properties of Air, Argon, Carbon Dioxide, Carbon Monoxide, Hydrogen, Nitrogen, Oxygen, and Steam*, Vol. 564 (US Department of Commerce, National Bureau of Standards, 1955).
  - [11] A.-G. Niculescu, D.-I. Tudorache, M. Bocioagă, D. E. Mihaiescu, T. Hadibarata, and A. M. Grumezescu, An Updated Overview of Silica Aerogel-Based Nanomaterials, *Nanomaterials* **14**, 469 (2024).
  - [12] S. Xu, Z. Zhou, Z. Liu, and P. Sharma, Concurrent stiffening and softening in hydrogels under dehydration, *Sci. Adv.* **9**, eade3240 (2023).
  - [13] G. Rehage, Elastic properties of crosslinked polymers, in *Macromolecular Chemistry-9*, edited by L. Cross (Butterworth-Heinemann, 1974) pp. 161–178.
  - [14] C. Licht, J. C. Rose, A. O. Anarkoli, D. Blondel, M. Roccio, T. Haraszti, D. B. Gehlen, J. A. Hubbell, M. P. Lutolf, and L. De Laporte, Synthetic 3D PEG-Anisogel Tailored with Fibronectin Fragments Induce Aligned Nerve Extension, *Biomacromolecules* **20**, 4075 (2019).
  - [15] U. Chippada, B. Yurke, and N. A. Langrana, Simultaneous determination of Young’s modulus, shear modulus, and Poisson’s ratio of soft hydrogels, *J. Mater. Res.* **25**, 545 (2010).
  - [16] W. Helfrich, Elastic Properties of Lipid Bilayers: Theory and Possible Experiments, *Zeitschrift für Naturforschung C* **28**, 693 (1973).
  - [17] O.-Y. Zhong-can and W. Helfrich, Bending energy of vesicle membranes: General expressions for the first, second, and third variation of the shape energy and applications to spheres and cylinders, *Phys. Rev. A* **39**, 5280 (1989).
  - [18] D. Wörthmüller, G. Ferraro, P. Sens, and M. Castellana, IRENE: A fluid layer finite-element software, <http://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827> (2025), [arXiv:2506.17827 \[physics\]](https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827).
  - [19] C.-C. Hsiung, *A First Course in Differential Geometry* (John Wiley & Sons, New York, USA, 1981).
  - [20] M. Deserno, Fluid lipid membranes: From differential geometry to curvature stresses, *Chemistry and Physics of Lipids* **185**, 11 (2015).
  - [21] S. C. Al-Izzi, P. Sens, and M. S. Turner, Shear-Driven Instabilities of Membrane Tubes and

- Dynammin-Induced Scission, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **125**, 018101 (2020).
- [22] M. Arroyo and A. DeSimone, Relaxation dynamics of fluid membranes, *Phys. Rev. E* **79**, 031915 (2009).
- [23] P.-G. De Gennes, F. Brochard-Wyart, and D. Quéré, *Capillarity and Wetting Phenomena* (Springer New York, New York, NY, 2004).
- [24] J. E. Marsden and T. J. R. Hughes, *Mathematical Foundations of Elasticity* (Dover, New York, 1994).
- [25] L. C. Evans, *Partial Differential Equations*, Graduate Studies in Mathematics (American Mathematical Society, 2010).
- [26] H. Reall, General Relativity, <https://www.damtp.cam.ac.uk/user/hsr1000/teaching.html>
- [27] L. Feng, S. Li, and S. Feng, Preparation and characterization of silicone rubber with high modulus via tension spring-type crosslinking, *RSC Adv.* **7**, 13130 (2017).
- [28] A. Müller, M. C. Wapler, and U. Wallrabe, A quick and accurate method to determine the Poisson's ratio and the coefficient of thermal expansion of PDMS, *Soft Matter* **15**, 779 (2019).
- [29] L.-H. Cai, T. E. Kodger, R. E. Guerra, A. F. Pegoraro, M. Rubinstein, and D. A. Weitz, Soft Poly(dimethylsiloxane) Elastomers from Architecture-Driven Entanglement Free Design, *Advanced Materials* **27**, 5132 (2015).
- [30] K. V. Pochivalov, A. N. Shilov, T. N. Lebedeva, A. N. Ilyasova, R. Y. Golovanov, A. V. Basko, and Y. V. Kudryavtsev, Development of vibration damping materials based on butyl rubber: A study of the phase equilibrium, rheological, and dynamic properties of compositions, *J of Applied Polymer Sci* **138**, 50196 (2021).
- [31] H. Goldstein, C. P. Poole, and J. L. Safko, *Classical Mechanics* (Pearson, 2004).
- [32] A. Logg, K.-A. Mardal, and G. Wells, eds., *Automated Solution of Differential Equations by the Finite Element Method: The FEniCS Book*, Lecture Notes in Computational Science and Engineering, Vol. 84 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 2012).
- [33] J. Crank and P. Nicolson, A practical method for numerical evaluation of solutions of partial differential equations of the heat-conduction type, *Math. Proc. Camb. Phil. Soc.* **43**, 50 (1947).
- [34] K. Goda, A multistep technique with implicit difference schemes for calculating two- or three-dimensional cavity flows, *Journal of Computational Physics* **30**, 76 (1979).
- [35] *Solving Ordinary Differential Equations I*, Springer Series in Computational Mathematics, Vol. 8 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 1993).
- [36] A. J. Chorin, Numerical solution of the Navier-Stokes equations, *Math. Comp.* **22**, 745 (1968).
- [37] Y. Bazilevs, V. M. Calo, T. J. R. Hughes, and Y. Zhang, Isogeometric fluid-structure interaction: Theory, algorithms, and computations, *Comput Mech* **43**, 3 (2008).